

AI FREEDOM MACHINE — AUTO-PILOT · GETTING STARTED

Welcome — let's set up your Auto-Pilot

Your 14-agent AI team, plus the parts that keep working while your computer is on: every sale delivered, a text on each order, your weekly content made and posted, and a daily ads check.

 Auto-Pilot Edition · Claude app, Code tab · Windows & Mac

Setup is four short steps, and **your assistant does the technical parts**. There's nothing to type into a command window. Just click, answer, and approve.

● What you need

A paid Claude plan

Pro is plenty. A bigger plan only gives more room, not more features.

The Claude desktop app

Free from claude.ai/download, for Windows or Mac. You'll use its **Code** tab. **Mac:** macOS 13.5 (Ventura) or newer; check **Apple menu** → **About This Mac**.

A computer that's on during your working hours

Automations run only while it's on, awake, and you're logged in (a locked screen is fine), inside the hours you choose.

About 30–45 minutes, spread out

15 to set up and get your first win. Connecting accounts can be another day.

The files in your folder look technical. Ignore them. You never need to open or edit `system` (your automation engine), `.env.template` (a blank form the connect page fills in), `.claude` (your 14 agents, already installed) or `GET-STARTED.md` and `UPDATING.md` (your assistant reads them to set up and, later, to update). On a Mac, `.env.template` and `.claude` are hidden, so you won't see them at all; that's normal.

● Set up in four steps

1

Put the folder somewhere permanent

First unzip your download. **Windows:** right-click it → **Extract All**. **Mac:** Safari usually unzips it for you, so you'll see the folder **AI Freedom Machine - Auto-Pilot** in Downloads already (the .zip goes to the Trash; that's normal). If you only see the .zip, double-click it. Then move the **AI Freedom Machine - Auto-Pilot** folder, the one with **READ ME FIRST** directly inside it (Windows sometimes wraps it in a second folder with the same name; use the inner one):

- **Windows:** into your **Documents** folder.
- **Mac:** into your **home folder**, the one with your name. To open it: in Finder choose **Go → Home** from the menu bar (or press **Shift + Cmd + H**), then drag the folder in. **Not** Desktop, Documents or Downloads: macOS blocks background jobs there.

Don't rename or move it later. If you ever do, just tell your assistant and it re-points everything.

2

Open the Claude desktop app, then the Code tab

Get it from claude.ai/download if you haven't already, and sign in. Click the **Code** tab, then choose your **AI Freedom Machine - Auto-Pilot** folder as your project.

Windows: if it asks you to install Git, say yes. It's a free tool the Code tab needs.

Mac: if a pop-up says *The "git" command requires the command line developer tools*, click **Install** (free, from Apple, a few minutes). It's the Mac version of the Windows Git step, and it may pop up again once or twice while it downloads; that's normal.

3

Say hello 🙋

let's get started

The first time, your assistant sets up its engine for you, asking before each part:

- It sets up **Node.js** (a free engine) if you don't have it. **Windows:** it installs it for you; if Windows asks "allow changes?", click **Yes**. **Mac:** your assistant sends you to nodejs.org. Click the green **LTS** button, open the downloaded .pkg, click **Continue** until it asks for your Mac password (you need an admin account for this one step), then restart the Claude app. Both are normal.
- It downloads its drawing and video tools (a few hundred MB, a few minutes). A wall of scrolling text is normal.
- It runs a quick **Health Check**, then asks **what hours your computer is usually on and you're logged in**, so automations only run when they'll actually work.

4

Connect your accounts on the connect page

Your assistant opens a small **connect page** in your browser. It runs on your computer only. Each account has a card with a box to paste into and a **Save & test** button. Your assistant tells you exactly where to find each item, one card at a time, and you look for the green check. **Your keys stay on your computer and never go into the chat.**

● Your first 15 minutes



Check your idea will sell (agent 1, about 10 minutes)

You don't need anything connected for this. When the menu appears, type **1**. Your **Idea Validator** asks five or six short questions, one at a time, with options to tap, then gives you a kind, clear verdict: **Go**, **Refine** or **Pivot**, with specific suggestions. It's saved in your folder, so your **Product Builder** (agent 2) picks up exactly where it left off. Not sure where to begin? Say **"guide me"**.

● The connect page, card by card

Your assistant walks these in this order. Do the three essentials first; everything else is optional and can wait.

Card	What it's for
 Stripe · essential	Sees each paid order so your product goes out. A read-only key is safest; the page shows whether you're in test or live mode.
 Gmail · essential	Delivers your product by email, and lets your Customer-Support Assistant read your support inbox. Uses a Google app password , not your normal one. The test sends you one email.
 Other email provider	Use this card <i>instead of</i> Gmail if your email is elsewhere.
 The product · essential	What buyers receive: the file in your Product folder, or a download link (best for big files).
 Phone alerts (Telegram)	A text on every sale, plus your weekly reports. Free and optional.
 AI writing key	Lets the weekly content research and write itself. Optional, and billed separately by Anthropic (usually a few dollars a month for weekly content). You can set a monthly limit there.
 Facebook & Instagram posting	Optional. Posting stays in preview until you personally say go. (Metricool is the simpler option; your assistant can explain both.)
 Meta ads	Optional, later. Your Meta Ads Agent walks this card with you when you're ready for ads.
 GoHighLevel CRM	Optional. Adds each buyer to your CRM and tags them so your emails start by themselves.

When payments and delivery are green, say **"turn on my automations"**. Your **Automation System** (agent 12) suggests the jobs that fit, starting with the **sale watcher** and **weekly summary**, and adds them only on your yes. **Mac:** after you turn on automations, your Mac shows **"Background Items Added — software from 'Node.js Foundation' added items that can run in the background"**. Nothing on screen says AI Freedom Machine; that's your Machine registering its schedule. Leave the switch for **Node.js Foundation** ON (it may show as **node** or **Unknown Developer**). If it's ever off, your automations stop; turn it back on in **System Settings → General → Login Items & Extensions** (called just Login Items on macOS 13 and 14). It's one switch for all your automations (and anything else on your Mac that runs through Node.js), so turning it off stops all of them at once.

💬 **You're always in control.** Your team asks a few questions, does the work, then gives you a 💡 recommendation. It asks permission before running things or saving files; that's normal. Nothing is posted, sent or spent without your yes: ads are always built **paused**, and posting stays in preview until you say go.

If something doesn't work

- **First, check** you're on the **Code** tab with your AI Freedom Machine folder chosen.
- **Windows, "install Git"?** Say yes. **"Allow changes?"** while Node installs? Click Yes. **Mac, a "command line developer tools" pop-up?** Click **Install**; it's the Mac version of the Git step and may pop up again once or twice while it downloads.
- **Mac, a folder-location warning?** The folder is somewhere macOS blocks background jobs. Move it to your home folder (in Finder: **Go** → **Home**, or **Shift + Cmd + H**, then drag it in) and tell your assistant; it re-points your automations.
- **The test email won't send, or says it's blocked?** **Windows:** your antivirus may be scanning outgoing mail (Norton, Avast, AVG and Kaspersky call it **"Mail Shield"** or **"Email scanning"**). Allow Node.js or turn off outgoing-email scanning there, then test again. **Mac:** try a different network first (some internet providers block outgoing email ports). Also check your spam folder.
- **An automation didn't run?** If your computer is asleep at the scheduled time, the job runs when it wakes (inside your hours). If it was off, or you were logged out, a daily job simply runs the next day, and a weekly job tries again the next day or two if those are working days; if it still misses, just say **"run my weekly content now"** to catch up. You can also ask your assistant to change your hours, or say **"is everything working?"** **Mac:** check one switch. When you turned on automations, your Mac showed **"Background Items Added — software from 'Node.js Foundation' added items that can run in the background"** (nothing on screen says AI Freedom Machine). Leave the switch for **Node.js Foundation** ON (it may show as **node** or **Unknown Developer**). If it's ever off, your automations stop; turn it back on in **System Settings** → **General** → **Login Items & Extensions** (called just Login Items on macOS 13 and 14).
- **Hit a usage limit?** Nothing is lost; limits reset over a few hours. Your chats with the team use your Claude plan, and big jobs use the most, so one thing at a time helps. Your scheduled jobs don't draw on it: the sale watcher, reports and posting are plain scripts, and the weekly writer uses the optional AI writing key.
- **Anything else:** tell your assistant exactly what you see, in plain words.

Help is close by

- **Instant answers:** the Help Vault at helpvault.theaifreedommachine.com
- **A human:** reply to your welcome email. It comes straight to me, and I answer personally, usually within one business day.

Please don't try to do everything tonight. One step at a time is genuinely faster.

-Ash, Founder, AI Systems Method